Abdullah Al Zahid

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Hiring Manager
Integrated Mobility
Dillon Consulting Limited

Re: Strategic Lead, Transportation Planning & Strategy (Toronto)

Dear Hiring Manager,

I would like to be considered for the Strategic Lead, Transportation Planning & Strategy position. I am an Assistant Planner in Transportation Planning at the City of Toronto, and I am writing knowing that this is a senior role for which I am early in my career.

The technical work the posting lists is work I have done at a smaller scale. At the City I review development applications and the transportation studies filed with them, analyze travel and network data, and coordinate with divisions, consultants, applicants and outside agencies whose priorities conflict. At Mott MacDonald I did traffic simulation in Synchro for Ontario Line construction staging, and at Metrolinx I ran OpenTrack simulations of GO rail services. My master's research at the University of Alberta used macroscopic and agent-based simulation. I also set up a command line workflow that pre-simulated slow orders in batches, cutting turnaround on scenario requests from days to hours, and built the Crew Variance Tool, a Python application that read large JSON operations files and summarised speed profiles and run-time variance across subdivisions.

I should be plain about the gaps, because they are large. The posting asks for twelve years of experience and six in project management; I have about four years of professional work. I have not led project teams or staff, managed budgets, developed business for a firm, or led proposals. I have not worked on Municipal Class Environmental Assessments, functional design of corridors, or master plans. I do not hold a P.Eng. I understand if the role is out of reach, and I would be glad to be considered for a transportation planner position if the team has one.

Thank you for considering my application.

Sincerely,

Abdullah Al Zahid

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